UX RESEARCH + MOBILE PRODUCT CONCEPT

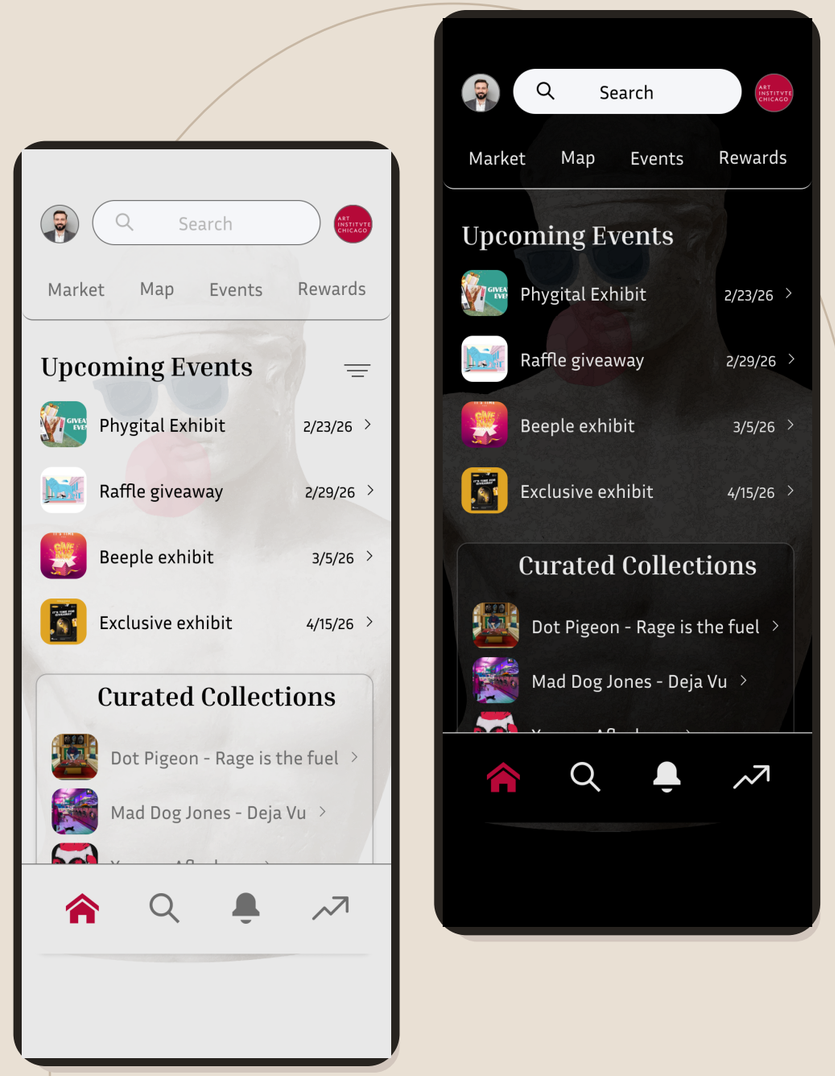
Beyond the gallery.

AIC Museum Experience

Exploring how a museum visit could feel more flexible, more social and worth returning for.

MY ROLE

Interviews, research synthesis, journey mapping, Figma screens and presentation design.



ORIGINAL LIGHT + DARK EXPLORATIONS

THE BRIEF

Make the visit feel worth the effort.

Our team explored a mobile companion concept for young museum visitors. I helped turn interview responses into a visitor journey and contributed to the screens and presentation.

MY CONTRIBUTION

01 Listen

I conducted interviews and reviewed responses.

02 Synthesize

I contributed to the visitor journey map.

03 Design + communicate

I designed Figma screens and created presentation slides.

PROJECT

Academic group concept

TEAM

Damir, Chris, Ryan, Andrew, Omar

COURSE

UXD 260: Research & Evaluation

TOOLS

Figma, Pitch

SCOPE

Research to mobile concept

Independent coursework exploring the Art Institute of Chicago experience; not commissioned client work or an official museum product.

LISTEN BEFORE PROPOSING

Twelve conversations about cultural outings.

12

semi-structured interviews

18-25

participant age range

20-30

minutes per interview

Our team spoke with college students and young professionals through remote and in-person sessions. The sample included frequent visitors, occasional visitors and people who tended to avoid museums.

WHAT WE EXPLORED

- Leisure habits and social planning
- Museum perceptions and attendance barriers
- Technology use during outings

> “Museums feel like you’re signing up for a whole thing.”
>
> Interview participant, age 20 | Team research deck, p. 7

PATTERNS IN THE INTERVIEWS

The friction was bigger than the interface.

01 ## Time commitment

Participants preferred flexible, low-pressure outings over a visit that felt like a major commitment.

02 ## Social coordination

Finding a time and organizing a group made spontaneous visits harder.

03 ## Cost sensitivity

Free days and discounts made attendance more appealing.

04 ## Passive engagement

Text-heavy exhibits could reduce energy and interest.

05 ## Useful technology

A phone was welcome when it added value rather than more work.

06 ## Social discovery

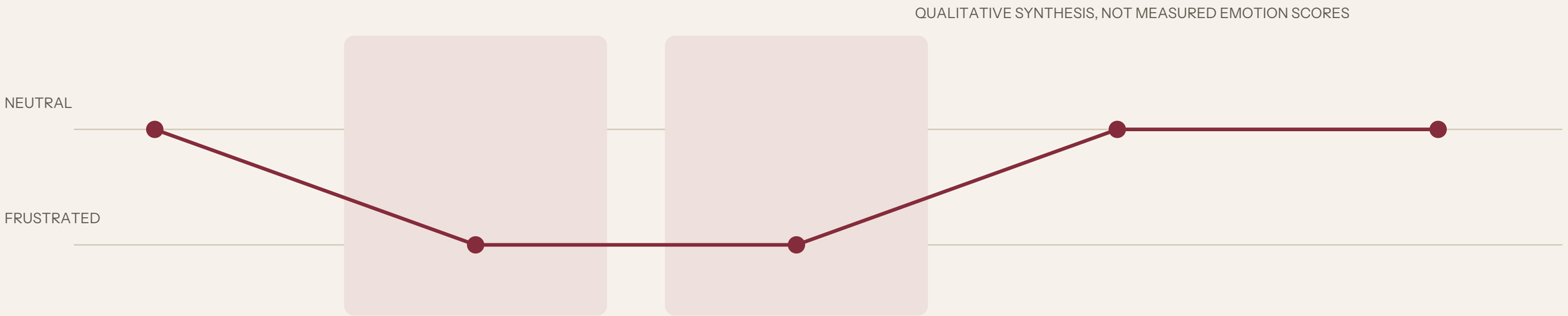
TikTok, Instagram and friends helped people discover experiences.

Qualitative themes from the team study; not population-wide or statistically representative findings.

VISITOR EMOTIONAL JOURNEY

The visit starts before the front door.

I contributed to the journey map. Planning and arrival were the clearest low points in our team synthesis.



Discovery

Finds an exhibit through social media; looks for a break from routine.

Planning

Checks prices, coordinates schedules and questions whether it is worth it.

Arrival

Finds parking, navigates an unfamiliar place and scans a ticket.

Engagement

Walks, takes photos and videos, and encounters limited interactivity.

Exit + reflection

Leaves unsure whether the experience justified the time and money.

Design opportunity: reduce uncertainty before arrival, then offer optional ways to engage and remember the visit.

INTERPRETATION, NOT VALIDATION

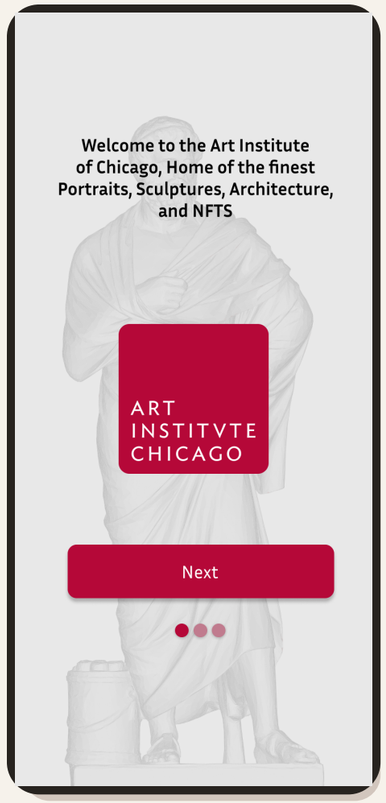
Give each idea a reason to exist.

RESEARCH THEME	CONCEPT RESPONSE	WHAT REMAINS TO TEST
Planning feels like work	Bring events and dates into a browsable home screen.	Can someone find a suitable event and understand its details?
Experiences feel passive	Explore an optional digital collecting layer alongside exhibits.	Does collecting add meaning, or distract from the art?
Social activity matters	Include a share action on the collectible detail screen.	Would visitors use it to share a visit with friends?
Technology needs clear value	Explain unfamiliar features and offer guest access.	Can visitors explore without feeling forced into an account?

These connections explain the design intent. They do not establish that the concept solved the research problems.

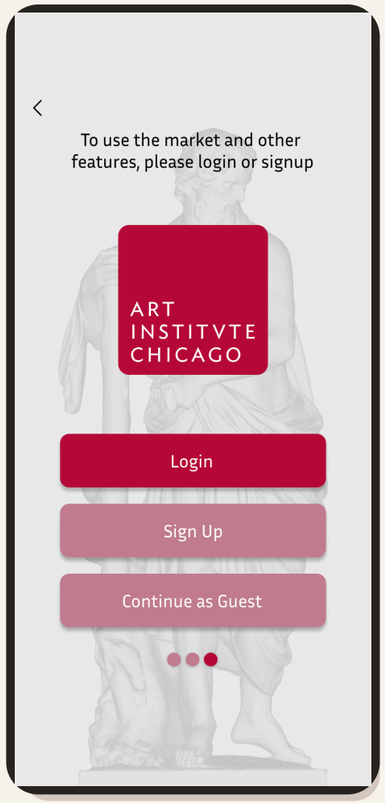
INTRODUCE THE EXPERIENCE

Explain the unfamiliar. Keep entry open.



01 / WELCOME

Museum imagery establishes the setting before the feature explanation.



02 / CHOOSE ACCESS

Login, sign-up and guest access give visitors different ways to enter.



03 / EXPLAIN COLLECTING

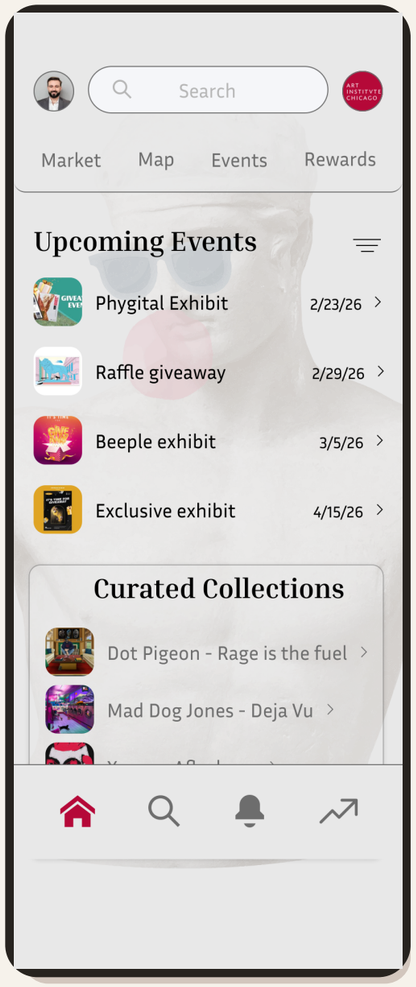
A dedicated screen introduces the NFT concept before the market.

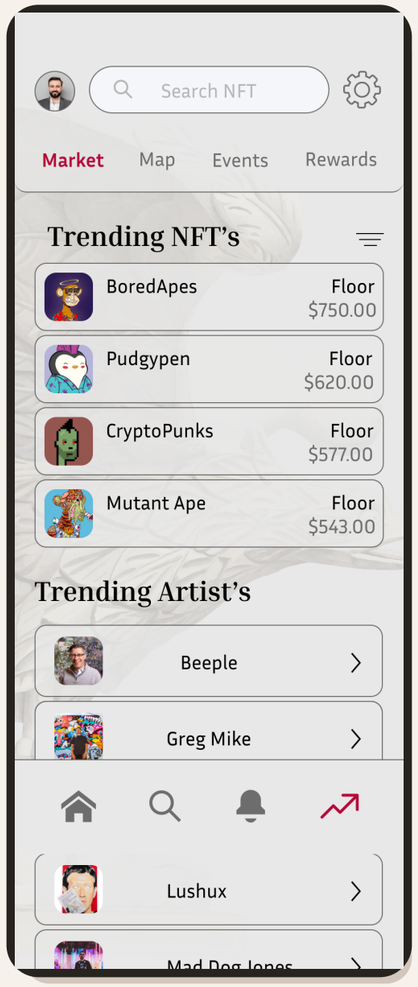
MY NEXT PASS

I would shorten the introduction and make the useful parts of the visit visible earlier. A first-time visitor should understand the value before learning the technology.

EVENTS + COLLECTIONS

Make browsing feel familiar.





01

Events lead the home

Upcoming events pair titles with dates, while curated collections provide a second browsing path.

02

Repeated rows create rhythm

Thumbnails, names and trailing arrows repeat, helping the interface feel predictable.

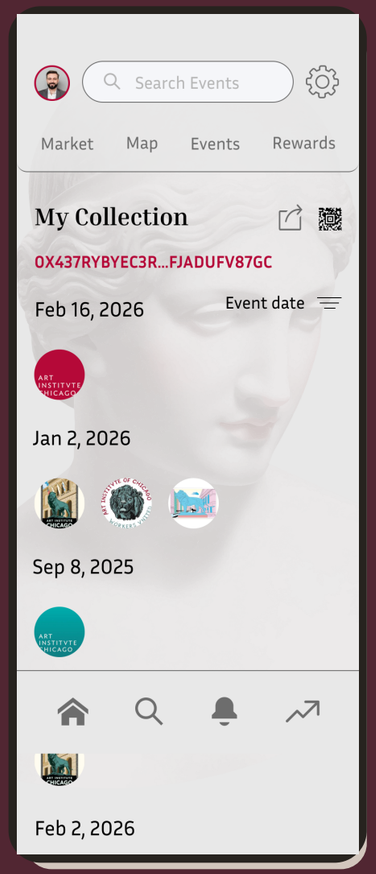
03

The market is a separate layer

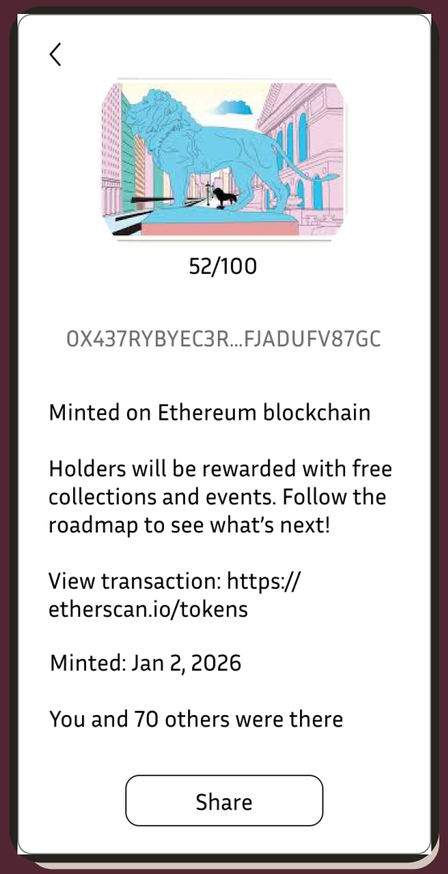
Trending collections and artists introduce digital collecting. Its value still needs to be tested with visitors.

BEYOND THE BUILDING

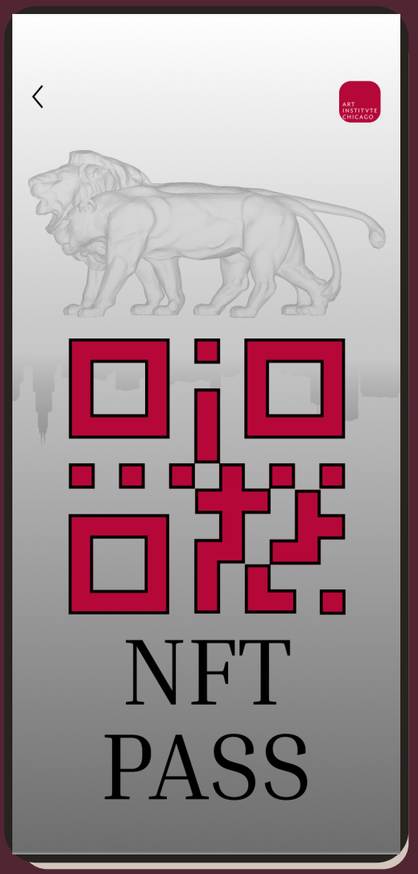
A record of the visit, with open questions.



MY COLLECTION



COLLECTIBLE DETAIL + SHARE



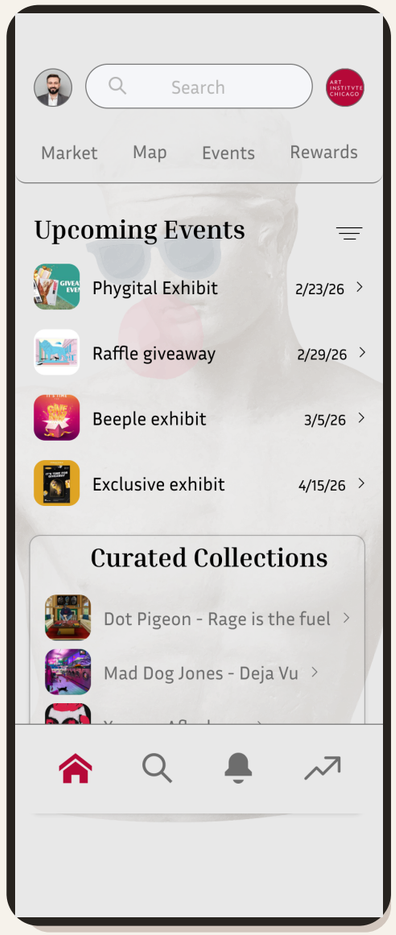
NFT PASS

The team explored collecting, rewards and an NFT pass as one possible extension of the visit. These are speculative product ideas, not demonstrated visitor needs.

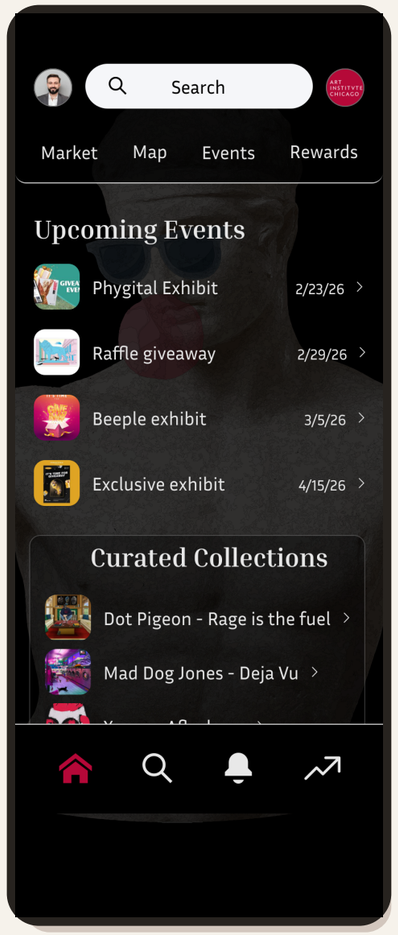
I would test a simpler saved-visit or digital keepsake experience before assuming a wallet or paid collectible is necessary.

A GALLERY-INSPIRED PRESENTATION

Art provides the character. Structure does the work.



ORIGINAL LIGHT EXPLORATION



ORIGINAL DARK EXPLORATION

One identity, two explorations

The original screens pair a red accent with sculptural imagery and serif headings. Light and dark versions explore the same visual language.

WARM PAPER

BURGUNDY

GALLERY INK

For this case study, warm paper, fine rules and generous spacing frame the original work. Burgundy marks important ideas without competing with the screenshots.

A MORE FOCUSED NEXT STEP

Polish the decisions, then test the experience.

01

Reduce competing navigation

The screens show a top category row and bottom icon navigation. I would clarify their separate roles and make the current location explicit.

02

Improve reading contrast

Sculpture imagery sits behind interface text. I would test quieter image treatment, text contrast and readable type sizes.

03

Check content accuracy

The event list includes February 29, 2026, which is not a valid date. I would audit dates, labels, spelling and sample data before testing.

04

Test the core value first

I would ask people to find an event, explain guest access and share a visit. Collecting would be tested as an optional extension.

No usability-test results or adoption outcomes were included in the supplied project materials.

WHAT I TAKE FORWARD

Useful technology starts with a clear need.

I contributed interviews, response review, journey mapping, Figma screens and presentation slides to a team research and concept project.

The strongest part of the work is the research story: time, cost and coordination can shape the visit before anyone reaches a gallery. The next step is to test whether our concept actually reduces that friction.

Research informs the direction. Testing has to earn the claims.

PROJECT RECORD

Academic group project
DePaul University
UXD 260: Research & Evaluation
Spring 2026

SOURCE MATERIALS

Portfolio_Case_Study_AIC.pdf
Research method: pp. 5-7
Journey and principles: pp. 19-21
Interface rationale: p. 23

Art Institute.pdf
Original 26-page screen export, including light and dark explorations and device mockups.

Screen artwork and institutional branding are shown as part of the original academic concept. No official affiliation is implied.